SINGAPORE EQUITY RESEARCH

# United Overseas Bank Ltd

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DBS Group Research

7 Aug 2026

## Relooking at asset quality

### Investment Overview

**Growing an enlarged franchise; targets doubling of wealth income by 2030.** UOB's acquisition of Citigroup's consumer businesses in Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, and Vietnam has been integrated, with UOB now having an enlarged customer base of ~8m. Amid macroeconomic uncertainty, management previously revised down its return on equity (ROE) from 14% to 12%-13%. Going forward, management is now targeting doubling of wealth income by 2030 from 2025 (SGD1,281m).

**Too early to call on dividends/ capital return plan.** Given UOB's lower loan growth assumptions and higher than expected rate of capital accretion going forward, there are renewed optimism on further dividends/ capital return plan. UOB has utilised 40% of its SGD2bn share buyback programme thus far. Management mentioned that they are reviewing it currently, but have not yet arrived at a decision. We believe it may be premature to call on further capital returns at this point in time.

**Keeping watch on asset quality still with chunk new NPA formation.** We remain watchful of asset quality risks in an environment of slower global growth amidst concerns of impact from Iran war, on top of UOB's commercial real estate (CRE) exposures. UOB's average loan-to-value (LTV) for office CRE continues to be ~50%, providing a buffer in the event underlying collateral valuations collapse. New NPA formation was higher SGD902mn (1Q26: S$341m) on the back of Greater China CRE new NPL. During 3Q25, UOB had taken a further SGD1.4bn in provisions, of which SGD615m pertained to general provisions top-up and management believes another top up exercise.

**Maintain HOLD, TP SGD42.50.** We maintain HOLD with higher TP of SGD42.50 (previous: SGD35.70) as we roll over valuation base, based on the Gordon Growth Model (12% ROE, 3% growth, and 10% (prev: 10.5%) cost of equity), representing ~1.3x FY27F, near the average of UOB's 15-year historical forward P/BV multiple. We remain cautious of a further deterioration in asset quality.

### Key Risks

**Deteriorating asset quality.** Higher-than-expected non-performing loans (NPLs) and recessionary risks could unwind expectations of credit cost and NPL declines, thus posing risks to earnings. A credit cycle will typically cause banks' share prices to derate.

### Forecasts and Valuation

| FY Dec (SGD mn) | FY2023A | FY2024A | FY2025A | FY2026F | FY2027F |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pre-prov. Profit | 7,691 | 7,956 | 7,620 | 7,963 | 8,489 |
| Net Profit | 5,711 | 6,045 | 4,682 | 5,808 | 6,207 |
| Net Pft (Pre Ex.) | 6,061 | 6,233 | 4,682 | 5,808 | 6,207 |
| Net Pft Gth (Pre-ex) (%) | 25.8 | 2.8 | -24.9 | 24.0 | 6.9 |
| EPS(S cts) | 339 | 359 | 278 | 344 | 368 |
| EPS Pre Ex. (S cts) | 360 | 370 | 278 | 344 | 368 |
| EPS Gth Pre Ex (%) | 25.8 | 2.8 | -24.9 | 24.0 | 6.9 |
| Diluted EPS (S cts) | 339 | 359 | 281 | 352 | 381 |
| PE Pre Ex. (x) | 12.1 | 11.8 | 15.7 | 12.7 | 11.8 |
| Net DPS(S cts) | 170 | 205 | 180 | 172 | 184 |
| Dividend Yield (%) | 3.9 | 4.7 | 4.1 | 4.0 | 4.2 |
| ROAE Pre Ex. (%) | 13.5 | 13.0 | 9.3 | 11.0 | 11.5 |
| ROAE (%) | 12.7 | 12.6 | 9.3 | 11.0 | 11.5 |
| ROA (%) | 1.1 | 1.1 | 0.8 | 1.0 | 1.0 |
| BV Per Share (S cts) | 2,742 | 2,950 | 3,040 | 3,212 | 3,212 |
| P/Book Value (x) | 1.6 | 1.5 | 1.4 | 1.4 | 1.4 |

*Source: Company, DBS*

# HOLD

**Last Traded Price:** SGD43.58
**Price Target 12-mth:** SGD42.50


### Analyst

Rui Wen Lim | ruiwenlim@dbs.com


- New NPA formation largely attributed to a Greater China real estate exposure, mixed use development in China booked in Hong Kong
- Management believes that FY26F credit costs can still be managed within guidance range (25-30bps)
- Fee guidance lowered to low-single digit on lower fees from loan-related fees and credit card fees

### Key Financial Data (FY Dec)

| | |
|---|---|
| Bloomberg Ticker | UOB SP |
| Sector | Banks |
| Market Cap (USDbn) | 56.14 |
| Major Shareholders (%) | |
| Wee Investments Pte | 8.1 |
| Wah Hin & Co Pte Ltd | 5.2 |
| Free Float (%) | 86.7 |

*Closing price as of 2026-08-06*
*Source: Twelve Data, DBS, Visible Alpha*

### Share Price




*Source: Twelve Data*


This report is based on content published on the Insights Direct platform which was last updated on 7 Aug 2026.
aa: JS, PY, CS


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**WHAT'S NEW**

Takeaways from 2Q26 briefings

Asset quality: New NPA formation of S$902m – two thirds was accounted for by the Greater China real estate exposure. This is a mixed-use development which has been on watchlist since last year and slipped into NPL this quarter, provisions have been set aside for it earlier already. Management remains comfortable that current provisions are more than adequate and that there is more than adequate room for UOB to operate on FY26F total credit costs to come within guidance of 25-30bps. Management believes Greater China book requires more time to navigate, provisions have been set aside with collaterals. Management concurs with Hong Kong banking peers' observations that might take a couple of years to see meaningful and significant recovery though there are bright spots in some sectors, not to say that challenges don't remain but management is confident that buffers set aside in place allow UOB to manage confidently. Management shared that NPA will be managed downwards towards more normalized levels and the spike in NPA is not a reflection of more NPAs appearing that management did not detect previously. Management believes there are not many exposures left for them to work through and deeper haircuts were taken for provisions set aside for vulnerable accounts. On coverage ratios, management believes that opportunistically where they can, they will look to beef up some of the ratios over time. GP to loans at 0.9% was at lower end of comfortable ratio range, there was no guidance on NPA coverage ratio (now 88%). Management does not expect to have another exercise to top up general provisions.

Wealth: Net new monies improved to S$3bn (1Q26: S$1bn); investment-to-aum ratio at 42%. Open architecture platform post UOBAM disposal envisaged to be good for building wealth platform and lifting investment-to-aum ratio with more products available to customers. Wealth continues to see strong momentum into June. Management believes that 2028 might be a more realistic timeline for the realization of HK wealth booking center though there is an existing private banking center in HK with RMs and coverage, booked in Singapore.

Fees guidance lowered: Fee guidance lowered from loan-related fees and card fees outlook changes. Fees from deals in pipeline see pushback. Card fees are one-third of fee incomes but outlook has changed as shift in spending patterns emerge. There is lower interchange fees in buckets that consumers now spend on with cost pressures from higher air miles redemption and higher scheme fees from Mastercard and Visa.

Loan growth: Wholesale grew 8% y/y, retail grew 4% y/y. UOB management shared that they have been making concerted efforts to reduce exposure to real estate.

NIM/NII: Exit NIM 1.71% July. NII expected to trend higher in 2H, management thinks has bottomed out with SORA seeing signs of stabilization and any upwards movement is supportive of margins going forward. 80% of loans are floating. Management reiterated need to balance absolute NII against measured pressure to maintain NIM guidance in view of NII priorities.

Deposits: CASA ratio decline saw a good chunk of deposits being invested during the quarter into wealth products.

ROE/ expenses/ Asset disposals: Targets 12-13% ROE and maintains low-single digit expense growth. Mr Wee wants more but mentioned that need to be realistic and need to invest for better customer services and spend new few years shifting the bank mix. Asset disposals are not a broader program to start divesting everything in portfolio. Management shared that the medium term strategy is to go asset light and target higher ROE businesses.

2Q26 results highlight:

- NII -8bps q/q decline (mainly on loan margin compression) but NII down 1% q/q as NIM decline partially offset by asset growth (loan growth +2% q/q increase).
- Fee income guidance lowered to low-single digit from high-single digit; saw wealth +11% q/q but trade/loan related fees continue to slide -4% q/q. Other non-interest income include non-recurring gain from asset divestments, otherwise treasury non-customer and customer income decline 11% q/q.
- NPA coverage decline to 88% on back of new NPA (1 Greater China real estate account under watch), GP loan coverage decline from 1.0% to 0.9%. Total credit costs managed q/q by GP writebacks despite higher SPs.

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## 2Q result summary

| S$m | 2Q26 | 2Q25 | 1Q26 | % y-o-y | % q-o-q | Comments |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Total income** | 3,595 | 3,465 | 3,422 | 4% | 5% | In-line with consensus |
| **Net interest income** | 2,297 | 2,336 | 2,324 | -2% | -1% | NII declined on loan margin compression, partially offset by asset growth; 8bps NIM q/q decline details under NIM line |
| **Non-interest income** | 1,297 | 1,129 | 1,099 | 15% | 18% | Net fee income of S$665m (+5% y/y, +4% q/q); wealth saw +11% q/q improvement to S$243m, offset by lower trade/loan related fees of S$246m (-4% q/q). Other non-interest income of S$632m (+28% y/y, +37% q/q) supported by non-recurring gains from asset divestments, both treasury non-customer and treasury customer income declined 11% q/q collectively but improved 11% y/y |
| **Operating expenses** | (1,629) | (1,535) | (1,523) | 6% | 7% | |
| **Pre-provision profit** | 1,965 | 1,929 | 1,899 | 2% | 3% | |
| **Provisions** | (211) | (279) | (203) | -24% | 4% | Credit cost higher q/q at S$211m, 24bps (1Q26: S$203m, 26bps). General allowance performing loans coverage declined q/q to 0.9% (1Q26: 1.0%); new NPA in Greater China real estate account; see NPL ratio line for more details.<br>General allowances (stage 1+2): -S$97m, -11bps (1Q26: S$-18m, -3bps)<br>Specific allowances (stage 3): S$344m, 39bps (1Q26: S$249m, 29bps) |
| **Net profit** | 1,478 | 1,338 | 1,437 | 10% | 3% | In-line with consensus |
| | | | | | | |
| **Dividends per share (Scts)** | 88 | 85 | - | 4% | n.a. | 50% dividend payout ratio; 40% of share buyback program utilised (S$794m) |
| | | | | | | |
| **NIM** | 1.74% | 1.91% | 1.82% | | | 8bps q/q decline breakdown: 5bps from asset repricing, 1bps from funding cost, 2bps from volume/mix |
| **NPL** | 1.6% | 1.6% | 1.5% | | | NPL ratio increased q/q; New NPA formation higher q/q at S$902m (1Q26: S$341m, average of S$577m for last 4 quarters) reflected downgrade of one closely watched real estate account in Greater China; greater China NPAs higher q/q and rest of the world NPAs at S$2,335m and S$437m (1Q26: S$1,730m and S$461m), Greater China and US NPL ratio at 4.8% and 1.2% (1Q26: 3.5% and 1.5%); NPA coverage declined to 88% (1Q26: 100%), unsecured NPA coverage at 306% (1Q26: 272%) |
| **Cost-to-income ratio** | 45.3% | 44.3% | 44.5% | | | |
| **ROE** | 11.6% | 11.1% | 11.5% | | | |
| **CET 1 CAR** | 15.4% | 15.3% | 15.3% | | | |
| **Total CAR** | 17.8% | 17.9% | 17.9% | | | |
| **Deposits (S$m)** | 437,176 | 405,076 | 426,731 | 8% | 2% | CASA ratio declined for second quarter q/q at 55.6% (1Q26: 57.0%) |
| **Loan book (Gross) (S$m)** | 361,411 | 342,900 | 353,837 | 5% | 2% | |
| **Loan-to-deposit ratio (Gross)** | 82.7% | 84.7% | 82.9% | | | |

*Source: Company, DBS*

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## Income Statement (SGD mn)

| FY DEC | FY2023A | FY2024A | FY2025A | FY2026F | FY2027F |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Net Interest Income | 9,679 | 9,674 | 9,355 | 9,451 | 9,910 |
| Non-Interest Income | 4,253 | 4,620 | 4,453 | 4,853 | 5,174 |
| Operating Income | 13,932 | 14,294 | 13,808 | 14,305 | 15,084 |
| Operating Expenses | -6,241 | -6,338 | -6,188 | -6,342 | -6,595 |
| Pre-provision Profit | 7,691 | 7,956 | 7,620 | 7,963 | 8,489 |
| Provisions | -921 | -926 | -2,042 | -1,059 | -1,102 |
| Associates | 93.00 | 121 | 79.00 | 119 | 119 |
| Exceptionals | -350 | -188 | - | - | - |
| **Pre-tax Profit** | **6,863** | **7,151** | **5,657** | **7,023** | **7,506** |
| Taxation | -1,138 | -1,092 | -962 | -1,194 | -1,276 |
| Minority Interests | -14.00 | -14.00 | -13.00 | -21.00 | -23.00 |
| Preference Dividend | - | - | - | - | - |
| **Net Profit** | **5,711** | **6,045** | **4,682** | **5,808** | **6,207** |
| Net Profit bef Except | 6,061 | 6,233 | 4,682 | 5,808 | 6,207 |
| Net Interest Income Gth (%) | 16.01 | -0.05 | -3.30 | 1.03 | 4.86 |
| Net Profit Gth bef Except (%) | 24.89 | 5.85 | -22.55 | 24.05 | 6.87 |
| Spread (%) | 1.91 | 1.84 | 1.76 | 1.68 | 1.68 |
| Net Interest Margin (%) | 2.09 | 2.03 | 1.89 | 1.80 | 1.82 |
| Cost-to-Income Ratio (%) | 44.80 | 44.34 | 44.81 | 44.33 | 43.72 |
| Net Int. Inc / Opg Inc. (%) | 69.47 | 67.68 | 67.75 | 66.07 | 65.70 |
| Non-Int. Inc / Opg inc. (%) | 30.53 | 32.32 | 32.25 | 33.93 | 34.30 |
| Fee Inc / Opg Income (%) | 16.04 | 16.76 | 18.61 | 19.62 | 20.12 |
| Oth Non-Int Inc / Opg Inc (%) | 14.48 | 15.57 | 13.64 | 14.31 | 14.18 |
| ROAE Pre Ex. (%) | 13.53 | 12.99 | 9.27 | 11.02 | 11.46 |
| ROAE (%) | 12.75 | 12.60 | 9.27 | 11.02 | 11.46 |

## Balance Sheet (SGD mn)

| FY DEC | FY2023A | FY2024A | FY2025A | FY2026F | FY2027F |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cash/Bank Balance | 52,350 | 38,577 | 35,742 | 37,529 | 39,406 |
| Government Securities | 38,280 | 46,851 | 62,695 | 63,639 | 64,596 |
| Inter Bank Assets | 35,093 | 37,432 | 32,954 | 33,859 | 35,477 |
| Total Net Loans & Advs. | 317,005 | 333,930 | 347,877 | 357,430 | 374,513 |
| Investment | 50,793 | 48,472 | 57,396 | 60,893 | 66,286 |
| Associates | 1,266 | 1,302 | 1,252 | 1,371 | 1,490 |
| Fixed Assets | 3,782 | 4,169 | 4,791 | 1,667 | 1,667 |
| Goodwill | 4,984 | 4,979 | 4,953 | 4,142 | 4,142 |
| Other Assets | 19,967 | 21,952 | 24,401 | 25,071 | 26,269 |
| Life Ass Fund Inv Assets | - | - | - | - | - |
| **Total Assets** | **523,520** | **537,664** | **572,061** | **585,601** | **613,847** |
| Customer Deposits | 385,469 | 403,978 | 425,938 | 447,235 | 469,597 |
| Inter Bank Deposits | 32,371 | 19,735 | 28,737 | 11,384 | 15,927 |
| Debts/Borrowings | 36,280 | 41,367 | 44,423 | 44,423 | 44,423 |
| Other Liabilities | 22,932 | 22,627 | 21,470 | 28,144 | 29,462 |
| Life Ass Fund Liabs | - | - | - | - | - |
| Minorities | 242 | 224 | 245 | 266 | 289 |
| Shareholders' Funds | 46,226 | 49,733 | 51,248 | 54,149 | 54,149 |
| **Total Liab& S/H's Funds** | **523,520** | **537,664** | **572,061** | **585,601** | **613,847** |

*Source: Company, DBS*

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## Target Price & Ratings History United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB_SP_Equity)




| S.No. | Date of Report | Closing Price | 12-mth Target Price | Rating |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2025-08-08 | 35.70 | 33.90 | HOLD |
| 2 | 2026-02-24 | 37.20 | 35.70 | HOLD |

*Source: DBS*
*Analyst: Rui Wen Lim*

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**BUY** (>15% total return over the next 12 months for small caps, >10% for large caps)
**HOLD** (-10% to +15% total return over the next 12 months for small caps, -10% to +10% for large caps)
**FULLY VALUED** (negative total return, i.e., > -10% over the next 12 months)
**SELL** (negative total return of > -20% over the next 3 months, with identifiable share price catalysts within this time frame)

**Share price appreciation + dividends*

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